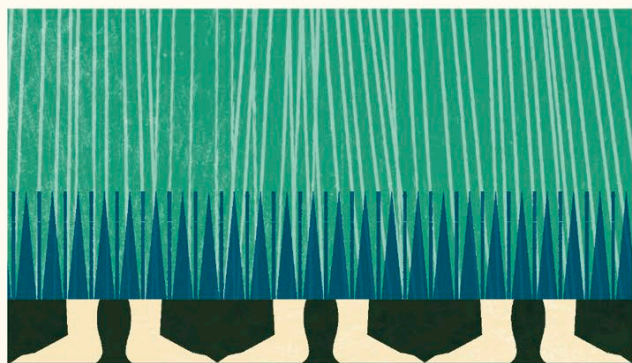




*Odin told Skadi that she could only choose her husband by looking at his feet.*

Odin stroked his beard. "If that will appease your anger, then so be it. However, you can only choose your husband by looking at his feet."

*Skadi agreed, and all the gods lined up behind a woollen drape with only their feet on show.*

Now, Skadi had already decided that handsome Baldr was the best match for her, so she picked the nicest pair of feet, assuming them to be his. In fact, they belonged to the sea-god, Njord.

Despite her disappointment, Skadi went ahead and married him. It was a lavish ceremony. The hall was decorated with flowers, music filled the air, and the gods ate, drank and danced for days. When the festivities wound down, the Aesir stumbled home, leaving the newlyweds to discuss their domestic arrangements.

This is when their problems began. Skadi wanted to live in the mountains, whereas Njord preferred the sea. In the end, they decided to compromise by staying at one home for nine days, and then swapping to the other.



*Skadi the giantess married the sea god Njord - the festivities lasted for days.*